



BigOrange.Marketing
A Content & Inbound Marketing Agency

Brand Voice

How BigOrange sounds, and how to write like it.

A working guide for the BigOrange team, outside writers, and the AI tools that draft for us. Read it once, then keep the checklist nearby.

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01 The voice in one sentence

BigOrange sounds like a sharp Cincinnati marketing friend: seasoned enough to explain the hard stuff, warm enough to lower the pressure, cheeky enough to call a pretty but useless website a cutie website.

02 Who we are talking to

One busy person, not a committee. Usually an owner or operator at an IT/MSP shop, a manufacturer, a landscaping company, or a home builder, already with a full plate. They want to know what BigOrange will build, check, and fix, and what that gets them.

Write to that one reader as "you." Assume they are smart about their own business and new to ours. Never talk down, never talk past them to impress another agency.

03 Voice pillars

01

Guide, not hero

We put the reader and their problem first. BigOrange is the guide who has walked this road before, not the star of the story.

Sounds like: - "Have a non-salesy business chat or get the real marketing support you need."

Does not sound like: - "We are the industry's most innovative full-service marketing powerhouse."

02

Plainspoken and warm

Ordinary, physical language. Dragging rocks uphill, an already-full plate, getting found. No systems talk where a real noun and verb will do.

Sounds like: - "Nobody remembers to do it the next day."

Does not sound like: - "Optimize your proprietary marketing framework."

03

Cheeky, then useful

One playful line, then something real. The joke opens the door, it does not carry the whole pitch. This is the cutie website energy: light, a little wry, never mean.

Sounds like: - "What does not marketing cost you?"

Does not sound like: - Three jokes in a row with nothing to back them up.

04

Proof-led and honest

Every warm or playful claim gets paired with something checkable: an award, a review count, a date, a defined process. We say what will be built, measured, or improved, not promised.

Sounds like: - "AI doesn't reward volume. It rewards clarity, credibility and structure."

Does not sound like: - "We guarantee page one rankings."

04 Tone by channel

CHANNEL	JOB	TONE DIAL	OPENING MOVE	CTA STYLE
Website	Explain the offer, lower the pressure, prove it works	Warm, plain, proof-heavy, least joking of all channels	Name the reader's problem before naming us	"Schedule a Non-Sales Call," "Request a Proposal": literal, low-pressure
Blog	Teach something real, show the expertise	Proof-led, declarative, expert but not stiff	A myth to bust or a question the reader is asking	"Read the full breakdown," a specific next post
Email	Move one relationship forward	Personal, direct, shortest sentences of any channel	The one thing that changed or matters now	A single, specific ask: book, reply, look at this
Social	Earn attention in a feed, sound human	Loosest and most playful, slang and fragments fine	An opinion, a joke, or a current moment	"See the site," "read the post," no funnel language
Client decks and proposals	Win trust with a specific plan	Warm but the most formal channel, confident, never hypey	The client's goal, in their own words	A named next step and date, not a generic "let's talk"

05 Writing rules

- 01 Write to one busy person as "you." A room full of readers writes worse copy than one real one.

- 02 Lead with what they are worried about or trying to get done, not with us.
- 03 Use plain verbs: find, fix, show, check, build, book, grow. They read faster and trust better than dressed-up ones.
- 04 Put a human consequence next to every technical capability. A feature nobody feels is a feature nobody remembers.
- 05 Follow every playful line with something useful. A joke with no payoff reads as filler, not personality.
- 06 Keep the rhythm uneven: question, answer, proof, then a long sentence, a short one, a punchline. Even rhythm reads like a form letter.
- 07 Use at most one playful phrase per section. More than that and the joke stops landing.
- 08 State the source, date, number, and any gap when presenting proof. An unsourced number is a guess in a nice outfit.
- 09 Never promise a guarantee. Say what will be built, checked, measured, or improved instead.
- 10 Make every call to action feel like help, not a funnel ambush.
- 11 Use citrus language sparingly. One squeeze per piece keeps it clever instead of forced.
- 12 Read every paragraph out loud. If a real person would not say it across a desk, rewrite it.

06 Words we use, words we avoid

USE

AVOID

clear, simple, real	agency filler words: the kind that promise a lot and mean nothing specific
refreshing, practical	vague systems nouns standing in for a real noun and verb
seasoned, genuine	jargon borrowed from a pitch deck nobody outside the industry would say out loud
guide, blueprint	anything that sounds like it was generated to fill space, not to answer a question
get found, get leads	promises with no source, date, or method behind them
grow, trust, off your plate	overclaimed superlatives an AI search tool would flag as unverifiable
next right step, show our work	

We keep agency filler words out entirely: verbs that promise a big change with no plan attached, nouns that describe a system instead of a thing a person can picture. If a sentence needs one to make sense, it is hiding a gap. Fill the gap, then cut the word.

Citrus language is our signature, not our whole vocabulary. Squeeze the day, fresh, refreshing, and juicy work when they show up once, doing a specific job. The cutie website joke, calling a pretty but useless site a cutie website, works the same way: it makes a real point about form without function, and only works when the point is true. It stops working the moment it shows up in every paragraph. One squeeze per piece is usually the ceiling.

07 Rhythm and structure

Keep sentences short on average. A longer sentence is fine when it earns its length with a real idea, not padding. Aim for two to four sentences per paragraph on the website and in email, a little more room in blog posts.

Use the question, answer, proof pattern often: ask the question the reader is actually holding ("What does not marketing cost you?"), answer it plainly, then back the answer with a number, a date, or a named process.

Open with the reader's situation or question, not our name or history. Close with a specific, literal next step: what they should click, book, or read, and what happens after. Never end on a vague "let's connect," end on the actual next thing.

08 Proof and honesty

Every number needs a source and a date, in the copy or a findable footnote. State it as reported, not rounded up to sound bigger.

BigOrange's own site states "50+ 5-Star Google Reviews." Use that exact figure, attributed to the site itself. Do not blend it with a different count from a different platform, aggregators count differently, and merging them into one number is not honest math, it is a guess dressed as a fact.

Cite awards and certifications by their exact stated name: Certified StoryBrand Guide, HubSpot Partner, Clutch Top Full Service Digital Company Ohio, Best in Cincy Business 2023, Best Digital Marketing Agencies Expertise Cincinnati 2025, WBENC certified, Google Partner, WP Engine Preferred Partner. Where two BigOrange pages word one differently, use the simpler wording and flag the mismatch rather than picking one silently.

Label drafts as drafts until a human checks the number, date, or claim inside them. A gap in the proof is not a reason to invent one, it is a reason to write "we will confirm this" and move on. "We do not have that yet" is more trustworthy than a confident guess, and it is a sentence a real person can say across a desk.

09 Before and after

BEFORE

We leverage a best-in-class, full-service digital marketing suite to drive game-changing growth for your business across every channel.

AFTER

You are busy running the business. We handle finding you new customers, checking what is working, and fixing what is not. That is the whole job.

BEFORE

Our team of experts will supercharge your organization with cutting-edge SEO strategies designed to maximize your online presence.

AFTER

Google decides who shows up first. We build the site and the content Google trusts, then show you the ranking report every month so you can see it happen.

BEFORE

BigOrange Marketing is proud to offer a comprehensive suite of tailored solutions built for your unique business needs.

AFTER

Every plan starts with your goal, not a menu. Tell us what you are trying to fix, we build the plan around that.

BEFORE

Don't miss this incredible opportunity to transform your digital footprint and dominate your local market today!

AFTER

Want to see what a stronger local presence actually looks like for your business? Schedule a non-sales call, no pressure, real advice.

BEFORE

Our AI-powered marketing solutions ensure your brand achieves maximum visibility across all digital touchpoints.

AFTER

AI search does not reward how much you post. It rewards clarity, credibility, and structure. Here is how we build all three into your site.

BEFORE

With decades of combined experience, our seasoned professionals deliver world-class results that consistently exceed client expectations.

AFTER

Margee has been doing this since before "AI search" was a phrase anyone used. She will tell you straight what is working and what is not.

10 Voice QA checklist

- 01 Does the section start with the reader's problem, not with us?
- 02 Could a real person say this across a desk without sounding ridiculous?
- 03 Is the benefit concrete, something the reader could picture?
- 04 Is there a source, date, or example behind every claim?
- 05 Did we use a vague systems word where a real noun and verb would work?
- 06 Is there at most one playful line here, and does it earn its place?
- 07 Does the call to action read like an offer to help, not a form push?
- 08 Would this line survive being read out loud to the client it describes?
- 09 If a number appears, is it stated the way the source states it, unrounded?
- 10 Does the piece close on a specific next step, not a vague sign-off?

11 AI and outside-writer instructions

You are writing as BigOrange.Marketing, a Cincinnati digital and AI marketing agency. Write to one busy reader as "you." Lead with their problem or goal before you mention BigOrange. Use plain verbs: find, fix, show, check, build, book, grow. Put a human consequence next to every technical idea. Keep rhythm uneven: short sentences next to longer ones, a question followed by a plain answer and then proof. Allow at most one playful or citrus line per section (fresh, refreshing, juicy, squeeze the day, or the cutie website joke for a pretty but useless site), and only when it is true and earns its place. Never guarantee results. State what will be built, checked, or measured instead. Every number, award, or claim needs a source

and a date; if you do not have one, write "needs a source" rather than inventing it. Avoid filler words that promise a lot and specify nothing. Close with one clear, low-pressure next step. Read every draft out loud before you submit it: if a real person would not say it across a desk, rewrite it.

12 Sources

- <https://bigorange.marketing/>
- <https://bigorange.marketing/about-big-orange-marketing/>
- <https://bigorange.marketing/services/>
- <https://bigorange.marketing/industries/>
- <https://bigorange.marketing/blog/>
- <https://bigorange.marketing/storybrand-website-implementation/>
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